

Regular Meeting
Monday/November 19, 2018
Medford School Committee
Council Chambers

Present: Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Mustone, Mr. Ruseau, Ms. Van der Kloot, Mr. Ruggiero, Mayor Burke, Superintendent Dr. Edouard-Vincent, Associate Superintendent Ms. Caldwell, Assistant Superintendent of Finance Ms. Patterson and Chioma Opara, High School Representative

Mayor Burke - Called meeting to order at 7:10 PM, Secretary please call the roll.

Attendance - 7-present 0 - absent

Approval of Minutes of November 5, 2018 - Motion to approve offered by Ms. Kreatz, seconded by Mr. Ruseau - motion passes

Approval of Bills/Transfer of Funds. Ms. DiBenedetto - I have a question about a tuition payment? Ms. Patterson - that is a reimbursement to a parent for a student who did not attend the program. Motion to approve by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Mustone.

Roll Call Vote - 7 - affirmative 0 in the negative, motion passes

Approval of payrolls - Motion to approve offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Kreatz

Roll Call Vote - 7 in the affirmative, 0 in the negative, motion passes

Report of the Secretary - Ms. Kreatz went over bills to WB Mason, and gave a sampling of what has been purchased: such as: water, school supplies and arts and crafts supplies.

Motion to accept the Secretary's report and place on file, by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Mr. Ruseau. Motion passes

Report of Committees - Special Education Sub Committee - Ms. DiBenedetto - 12 people were in attendance, and there were two items on the agenda: Disability awareness program and Out of School Time. Our hope is to be able incorporate disability awareness into schools, and provide some teacher training. We also had some input from representatives from our new partners at Lesley University. Regarding Out of School Time - we want to be sure we are serving everyone in the community. Is there a way to expand it? How can we get more staff? This was our first

meeting, we are planning to convene our next meeting soon. It was very productive and we are seeing some changes.

Motion to accept Special Education Sub Committee Report by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Mr. Ruseau. Motion passes.

Ms. Van der Kloot - May we suspend the rules to discuss the School Committee Conference?

Mayor Burke - Is it on the agenda? Ms. Van der Kloot - No. Mayor Burke - We will wait until next meeting then

Report of the Superintendent - Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I would like to show a brief video of the improvements made at the Roberts Elementary School Playground. I would also like to introduce Ms. Emily Lazzaro, as my new Special Executive Assistant. In addition, we had our first official snow event for the season. I appreciate the work of Mr. McLaughlin, Director of Building and Grounds who was out at 3 AM and in constant discussion with our wonderful Department of Public Works. It was a bit exciting and everyone working together made it all work out pretty well. In addition, I had the opportunity to meet with Ms. Federica Sereni, the new Italian Consulate General, Ms. Maria Gioconda Motta, M. Ed., Executive Director of Education, for C.A.S. IT, (C.A.S. IT is the state's leading organization in promoting the Italian language in Massachusetts schools), Associate Superintendent Diane Caldwell, Director of Curriculum, Instruction and Foreign Language Dr. Bernadette Ricciardelli, Lead Teacher for Foreign Language Vilma Bibeau, and former School Committee Member Ann Marie Cugno, came to Bistro 489 in order to continue the 23 year partnership between the Consulate General of Italy and the Medford Public Schools. We discussed different educational opportunities, internship possibilities and the potential of both student and teacher international exchanges. Special thanks to Ann Marie Cugno and MVTHS Principal Chad Fallon for their assistance in helping to arrange this important meeting. I also had the opportunity to participate in the Center for Citizenship and Social Responsibility and Mayor Stephanie Burke hosted a Veterans walk on Veteran's Day. The walk began after a brief speaking program at Medford City Hall. The walk was sponsored by DMSE Sports, The Boston Foundation, Medford Rotary Club, Bates Insurance, Tufts University-Jonathan M. Tisch College of Civic Life, Hickok & Boardman Insurance Company, Stanley Painting, along with Wegmans and Carroll's Restaurant. Proceeds from the walk will be forwarded to NEADS, (service dogs for veterans) and The Krystle Campbell Community Betterment Project. Many community members, as well as, Kathy Kreatz, Associate Superintendent Diane Caldwell, Assistant Superintendent of Finance Kirsteen Patterson, CCSR Program Director Richard Trotta, CCSR Program Advisor Michael Skorker, Director of Veterans Services Michael Durham and many CCSR students did the walk with us. During our monthly Administrative Meeting, we were able to continue to discuss establishing our district wide priorities by looking at instruction, troubleshooting and working collaboratively. I attended our monthly New Superintendent Induction Training in Marlboro,

hosted by MASS and MASC. I also had the opportunity to meet with our State Senator Patricia Jehlen in our Bistro and discussed educational priorities for the school district. We visited a few of the vocational shops. The Senator is interested in voke programming and how it folds into our bigger program. She plans to return and see more of Medford High School. Yesterday, I went to the Mustang Hall of Fame Induction Ceremony. The President, Dave Crowley, said to me, this is the first time we had so much representation from the school district. He was very pleased. Mayor Burke was there, as well as, Paul D'Alleva, Chad Fallon, Diane Guarino, Nick Tucci, and Diane Caldwell. It was wonderful to see all those inducted especially our own Jack Dempsey. It is wonderful how sports has played a positive role in so many lives and how they have gone on to have successful careers. I also heard the Jingle Bell Run was a great success. Diane Caldwell went to this event for families and children of all ages. Wednesday is an early release day. Happy Thanksgiving to all!

Mayor Burke - The Jingle Bell Run had about 600 people. It was very successful and all the funds raised goes back to the schools. I'm sure we'll have them at a future meeting. Ms. Van der Kloot - It is truly Judy Lonergan's baby and she put a lot of work into it and got it off the ground and all for the schools benefit.

Superintendent Dr. Edouard-Vincent- I would like to call upon Rachel Perry who will discuss the Project Here Substance Use Prevention Curriculum Grant. Ms. Perry -Project Here has provided selected middle schools fundings to implement one of three evidenced-based prevention curricula: Botvin LifeSkills Training , Michigan Model for Health, or Positive Action. These three curricula were selected to provide schools with the flexibility to choose from universal prevention curricula that have proven to positively impact students' behavior, while considering their local, school and community needs. Ms. Van der Kloot - How will money be used? Ms. Perry - We will use the \$13,000 for training for our staff, which will include substance use prevention units for our physical education and health teachers along with our guidance staff. We have been able to increase our substance abuse curriculum over the past 4 years. We have come a long way. Mayor Burke - How many teachers/staff will benefit? Ms. Perry - 22. All elementary staff have been trained.

Mayor Burke on the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto to accept this report and place on file, seconded by Mr. Ruseau. Motion passes.

Superintendent Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I would like to call upon Toni Wray who will provide a report on the Childhood Obesity Prevention Program. Ms. Wray - This is by way of a donation to the Medford Public School via Hallmark Health/Melrose Wakefield Hospital. I'd like to thank Mr. Ruseau for bringing this to our attention. The Melrose-Wakefield Hospital has offered to support childhood obesity programs for Medford students. It's goal is to provide strategies to

address this issue. Data collected by Medford school nurses for the Department of Public Health indicated the percentage of overweight/obese grade 4 students ranges between 43% and 45%. We would like to provide interventions in Medford such as: dedicated recess time, regularly scheduled physical education classes, availability of healthy foods, especially fresh fruit/vegetables, and the availability of community recreation programs. All of these options tend to increase student wellness. This \$2,000 donation, was initially funded by the Bruins Foundation with the goal to increase physical education for all children. We planned to use this gift to augment our physical education programs for all grade 4 students, by implementing healthy walking into a student's lifestyle. All grade 4 students will receive a personal pedometer to record their daily walking activity. Students will log in their steps in a journal, and results from across the district will be compared. The class with the highest number of steps will be awarded a prize. Mr. Ruseau - This happened very quickly! This level of efficiency needs to be highlighted! Mr. Ruggiero - Do we have a sense of obesity data...different grades for example? Ms. Wray - These are the grades we follow through the Department of Public Health: I gave you Grade 4. Also, Grade 1 - 32%-34%, Grade 7 - 34-35%, Grade 10 - 39-42%. Mr. Ruggiero - Grade 4 seems to be the biggest problem? Ms. Wray - Well, grade 4 is considered pre-puberty, so it is normally what happens. But it is a great age to get kids get easily engaged in projects like this. Mr. Ruggiero - The health effects of obesity can be frightening. Can our lunch options be explored? I think this is a serious problem. Ms. Wray - Our nutrition program meets the federal guidelines. Mr. Ruggiero - Well, that doesn't say much. Mr. Ruseau- How do our numbers compare with surrounding communities? Ms. Wray - We are fairly similar. Mr. Ruggiero - I'd like to request a statistics by grade from the Superintendent. Ms. Wray - we don't do heights & weights for every grade, just the grades I already mentioned.

Mayor Burke - On the motion to accept this report and place on file by Mr. Ruseau and seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion passes.

Superintendent Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I would like to call upon Stacey Schulman who will provide a report on some of our Social Emotional Learning Initiatives that are being worked on throughout the district. Ms. Schulman - We have restarted the Social Emotional Learning Committee on two levels: one with our community partners, and one with school administration. These teams will review emerging needs and how we are supporting students, as well as, some of the processes, procedures and methodology we use on a daily basis. We hope to start SEL teams in each school to focus on individual needs in the buildings. Our goal is for SEL to be the common language throughout district. We have done professional development. We have partnerships with Eliot Human Services, the Board of Health, and the Mystic Valley Health Coalition. We have expanded the Zones of Regulation methodology throughout all of the elementary and middle schools. Working with Respond, domestic violence prevention training was provided to our high school health classes. The Columbus received training in providing a

supportive environment for LGBT youth and families. Counselors participated in Crisis Response Training on PD Day. We have partnered with the NAN Project to bring mental health awareness & suicide prevention to the high school faculty. Eliot Human Services will join McGlynn Faculty on December 17th to discuss Mental Health in the Classroom. We also plan to add SEL to our website. Ms Van der Kloot - The Medford Educational Foundation was asked for signage? But can you be more specific? Ms. Schulman - We can always use more posters. We are looking for the color posters which are more expensive. I will ask the counselors what they feel is necessary and take an inventory and get back to you. Ms. Van der Kloot - We need a better, more comprehensive approach - Mr. Ruseau - I saw a Yale Professor speak on SEL at a conference. Maybe Superintendent can look into him. He was very inspiring. Also, I know that we can making trainings available but can't make mandatory due to contracts. So do you know the total number of those who took the training? Ms. Schulman - I will get back to you with that information. Mr. Ruseau - I was happy to hear about the Columbus training. Could that be beneficial in all schools so all students could benefit from it? Also, why is NAN Project just in high school? Ms. Schulman - They haven't certified the Middle School program yet, but intend to do so next year, for free. Mayor Burke - Are there SEL committees at each school? Ms. Schulman - That is our goal. Ms. DiBenedetto - I'd like to request a follow up report so we can get answers about the trainings? Can we email you our questions? Also, is the Curtis Tufts involved? They should be present at these trainings, as they are experts in our district and have a lot of value. And, how do we make our programs meet those needs? Proactive vs. reactive? Ms. Opara, high school representative - We talk a lot about mental health & mental health awareness. Is training available for high school students? Ms. Schulman - We are offering the training. Peer mentors will present in classes. We are looking for volunteers. Mr. Ruggiero - Do we compile statistics on depression. Ms. Wray - If a doctor files a report with us, we keep it on file. Mr. Ruggiero - What about students who report suicidal thoughts? Ms. Wray - School brains doesn't provide for that. We do provide an end of year report. We have 660 students identified in district with mental health issues, but parents can control that information, so I think it's a much smaller number than really exists. Mr. Ruggiero - Health data would be interesting...obesity, drug use and depression numbers. Ms. Wray - High School data - vaping/pot/alcohol - 19%-24% / Middle School - 6%. Mr. Ruggiero - Is this provided to the State, so we can compare to other cities? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Not sure how much I'd have access too. Ms. Wray - We report to DPH - but I don't have access. Mr. Ruggiero - Can we request that from DPH? Mr. Ruseau - last December's School Committee meeting had a survey report from Penny. Is that an annual report? Ms. Wray - That is a Communities that Care report.

Mayor Burke - Motion by Ms. Van der Kloot to approve and place this report on file, amended by questions, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto, motion passes.

Superintendent Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I would like to call upon Dr. Bernadette Ricciardelli who will provide details about Professional Development Day. Dr. Ricciardelli - The first of two district wide professional development days was held on November 6th. Our elementary teachers participated in day long math protocols or RTI training. The secondary level attended content workshops in the morning & school based workshops in the afternoon. Specialists participated in day-long workshops led by their respective department administrator. Presenters included out of district professionals, noted for their expertise in the particular content area, while other workshops were led by Medford public school's faculty members. The district collected and analyzed feedback from the day. Out of a possible 5 being the highest, the results were between 4.6- 4.9. So overall very positive. Mayor Burke - Do you take any teacher suggestions? Dr. Ricciardelli - Overall they were happy. Content related, those teachers wanted more time in workshops, but we do have to balance it all, and provide a broader scope as well. Mr. Ruseau - Was teaching pathways to music curriculum well received? Dr. Ricciardelli - It was and it was conducted by industry teachers. Mr. Ruseau - Media Technology - computer science in Massachusetts is watered down. Computer science includes typing, but that's not computer science frameworks. Dr. Ricciardelli - They call it keyboarding. In ELA frameworks too. There is room for improvement. Sticking with MA frameworks begs for discussion for a later date. Mr. Ruggiero - How does it compare to last year? Dr. Ricciardelli - Well, last year, we had two PD days, but one was dedicated to security. Mayor Burke - How often does PD committee meet? Dr. Ricciardelli - The last time it met, was, I think, in 2017. Overall PD day was a collaborative effort that went very well.

Mayor Burke - Motion to accept and place this report on file by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion passes

Superintendent Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Associate Superintendent Diane Caldwell will provide a report on the ABCD Award - Ms. Caldwell - We often take the opportunity here to celebrate our kids and today we have one of our own to celebrate. Marie Cassidy could you please come forward? Marie has been the Director of the Medford Family Network for 25 years, and has been a tireless advocate and community collaborator. The Medford Family Network provides so many programs free of charge to Medford families who live or work in Medford. Marie's rooms are filled with joy. I want to share a particular story that I heard at the Family Network...A family lost their child, were floundering and unable to help their younger son cope. A friend suggested the Medford Family Network. There were counselors available to help them. And there was staff there to support both the parents and the child. This helped this family so much that they eventually became leaders for the Medford Family Network, paying it forward for other families. All thanks to Marie Cassidy! Another quick story, Marie's husband wanted to go on vacation, but Marie likes to work. Her husband wanted to take her Paris. So, Marie reluctantly goes, but asks me to supervise the Fun Family Night at Wright's Pond for her. She had 2 car

loads of stuff set aside for me, so the kids coming to the pond could play. It's my pleasure to present and congratulate Marie. Mayor Burke - Please approach the chair so we can present you with a School Committee Award. We are so proud to know you. You always puts families first I have a quick story too. Marie was pulling in at Wrights Pond for an event, and her car got rear ended She said, oh, don't worry about me - we need to get the toys to the kids! You do an amazing job - you are the spirit of our community. Ms. Cassidy - I absolutely love this opportunity. I am a born and bred Medford girl, who started as a park instructor, later became a social worker - , then a head start teacher, and later worked for the Office for Children. The Medford Family Network allows me to put all my skills together in one place. For 25 years, I have experienced joys, frustrations and many successes. We have grown as our population has changed. We have an amazing staff & community,partners. We give our best everyday. I am blessed with an amazing staff who loves what they do, which reflects back onto this school system. We teach the five protective factors: Social connections, parent resilience, child development & parenting education, support in times of needs, (food clothing housing domestic violence), social/emotional competence up until age 8 ...I'm blessed to be here!

Mayor Burke - On the motion to accept this report and place on file, by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Mr. Ruseau. Motion passes.

Superintendent Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Paul D'Alleva and Chad Fallon will know discuss Grade 8 Open House. Mr. D'Alleva - On October 18th, MHS/MVTHS hosted 8th grade open house. We did it slightly different this year, by providing student led tours, as well as, allowing for self guided tours later in evening. I felt families wanted a different experience and used my experience at the Andrews for MHS/MVTHS. We realized that there are a lot of stops for a short amount of time - not everyone could get everywhere they wanted to do - some broke off of student led tours to get to where they wanted. People seemed pretty positive, however, unfortunately, we did not get as many responses to the survey as we had hoped. Mr. Fallon - We had 17 programs open, with demonstrations being held in 5 of the programs. Ms. DiBenedetto - Didn't MVTHS used to hold their own open house on a different night? Mr. D'Alleva - Yes, but we are now one school, so we try not to separate it. Plus with contractual issues, we try to balance it all. Ms. Van der Kloot - I attended, and it was difficult to get everywhere. The tour guides did a terrific job. I also heard that some rooms were too hot? Mr. Fallon - The heat has been regulated. Mr. McLaughlin - on Nov 6th, we did a heat evaluation. Ms. Van der Kloot - It's a lot to see in a short span of time. Maybe continue to refine the process. Mayor Burke - Could we do an additional night? Mr. D'Alleva - Well, again, we have contractual issues. Mr. Fallon - The teachers on MVTHS side, would do it on a weekend for example, as they are passionate about it, so we are working on it. We have a bus, so we can bring our 8th graders here to experience the Voke. Stay tuned as we work out the details. Ms. DiBenedetto - Will summer program continue? Will you advertise that early? Mr. D'Alleva -

Yes, in March. Ms. Kreatz - Kathy - I was there and liked the student guided tours. Maybe just cut those tours shorter? Mr. D'Alleva - Chad and I debriefed with staff. We know we can improve. Ms. Kreatz - I just wanted to say that the cleanliness of the school was noted!

Mayor Burke - Motion to accept this report and place on file, by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. Kreatz. Motion passes.

Superintendent Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Dr. Nicole Chiesa will discuss the Annual Veterans Day Program. Dr. Chiesa - This is our 18th year of hosting this important program. It gives students the opportunity to directly interact with veterans. It is a very rewarding experience for all. Many of the veterans are graduates of MHS/MVTHS. It's an authentic piece of history that is shared amongst the students. Mayor Burke - It was a great way for the new Veterans Director to meet the veterans. Dr. Chiesa - Mr. Durham did a great job. Veterans give up their whole day, which is so gracious of them. Ms. Opara, high school representative - I came to MHS in February from another school. This is the first time I was able to see this program. A lot of peers mentioned it to me. It was an awesome thing to see. Very meaningful. Thank you!

Mayor Burke - On the motion to accept and place this report on file, by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot. Motion passes.

Mayor Burke - Ms. Van der Kloot, makes motion to move Negotiations and Legal matters to end of calendar, Mr. Ruseau, seconds the motion. Motion carries.

Mayor Burke - New Business - Mr. Ruggiero - When I decided to run, I often asked, why are most school committee meetings so poorly attended? Are people disinterested/disengaged? But knocking doors told me otherwise. It is the time that we meet that is challenging for parents to attend and voice their opinions; due to late night work schedules, bedtimes, Parent Teacher conferences, etc. So I am suggesting two meetings that will discuss the budget and after school activities with the goals of these meetings to generate momentum on projects, so we can move forward. I would like PTO's to provide child care and food options for these meetings or maybe even the Bistro, so that everyone can contribute. We have untapped talent within our community ... professors or artists that could volunteer their time in our schools - we need to work out a schedule. Perhaps only 1 meeting this year is possible? Mr. Ruseau - Have you looked to see if other communities have done it and if so, what is the success of it? Mr. Ruggiero - We did it in the district I used to work for. I'm not sure MA does it. We could pilot it. Mr. Ruseau - So we will not deliberate, or have a quorum? Is it an actual meeting? Mr. Ruggiero - We can leave it open, But if it is an official meeting? Roll calls? MASC said we could host a weekend mtg. Mayor Burke - It would have to be like this if it's an official meeting. Mr. Ruseau - Well, this isn't a dinner table format. Mr. Ruggiero - Could we have break out session and suspend the

rules? Ms. Mustone - I appreciate you want parents to get here. But, we have 8 subcommittees that parents can attend and/or reach out to us. I am not sure this would get parents here. Maybe a meeting hosted by the Community Relations subcommittee, inviting parents might work better. Easier to schedule a subcommittee. Mr. Ruggiero - But, wouldn't it be great to make it pro active rather than reactive? Important for new ideas to be proposed. Ms. Mustone - Parents have reached out to me/us. I haven't heard that they can't attend SC meetings. Mr. Ruggiero - I think the issue is inviting people to provide a resource so parents can engage. Ms. Mustone - I just disagree. Ms. Kreatz - Maybe we can conduct a survey? Having a school committee meeting on a Saturday? We already have the school committee meetings have already been scheduled for the year. What about our Administrators? Not sure if that can work contractually. No parents have approached me on this. So many events on weekends that I don't know who could attend? Ms. DiBenedetto - Just trying to brainstorm here. Maybe we could host a meet the School Committee, as opposed to a more formal meeting. So parents could have access to us and discuss priorities, have an open dialogue. Is that what you are looking for? Ms. Kreatz - Like a committee of the whole? Mr. Ruggiero - We can debate together. Dozens of parents have approached me. Make it an event type atmosphere so we have something for the children. Mayor Burke - This happens at other events that we already attend. Ms. Van der Kloot - All of the ideas don't seem to fit together for me. I mean in February, the MFN hosts the annual ice cream social. Many of us are there. We could start 45 minutes earlier for example, so parents have the opportunity to meet the school committee members. Formalize it that way. We used to have An Evening with the Superintendent and School Committee. We could maybe do that again? But we need a more targeted goal. The volunteer aspect is another issue. I think just too much for one meeting. I just can't support it until it is more focused. Your idea certainly has value. But maybe at existing venues. I think we shouldn't vote on it, but rather send it back to Community Relations subcommittee. Ms. Kreatz - I second that motion. The motion carries.

The Medford School Committee offers its condolences to the families of Mrs. Mary Bulen, grandmother of Mrs. Michele Bissell and her husband John Bissell, Mother of Mrs. Janet Riccardi, and great grandmother of Ms. Janelle DeSanto. As well as, to the family of Ernest Lorenz, a former Medford Public Schools custodian.

Ms. DiBenedetto - Before we go into executive session, I would like to go over the status of the PTO registration form report? The status of the Safety Report? Mayor Burke - We will have a separate meeting for that, to go over the executive summary of that report. Ms. DiBenedetto - I plan to schedule a second meeting for the Disability Awareness program. And I don't want to forget the January payrolls

Mayor Burke - Motion to go into Executive Session made by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Ms. Kreatz.

Roll Call Vote - 7 - in the affirmative - 0 in the negative, motion passes

Mayor Burke - We will enter executive session now - 9:05 PM

Per Secretary Kathy Kreatz - Executive session ended at 10:46 PM and all members were in attendance.